

Advisory Engagement Letter

A strategic advisory engagement between 4orm Finance and Dean McCall. Companion documents: Compensation and Terms Schedule (Schedule A), the Legacy Token Instrument, and the Mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement. Intellectual property is assigned within this letter at Section 6.8, so a single signature settles the engagement, the terms, and IP together.

DATE July 7, 2026

TO Dean McCall

FROM Chad Johnston, on behalf of 4orm Finance

RE Strategic advisor engagement: scope, milestones, coordination, term, and transition to a role

Dear Dean,

Thank you for the time, the candor, and the introductions. This letter sets out the terms on which 4orm Finance (the “Company”) would like to engage you as a strategic advisor. The Company is building the settlement layer that makes a tokenized transfer final and legal across two regulated institutions in Canada. The wedge is the cash leg, a tokenized bank deposit issued by the bank, with the Company operating the ledger of record, the compliance gate, and the settlement orchestration.

The terms below are intended to be clear, fair, and aligned with the principle you put well in our meeting: everyone gets something, and it vests. This letter covers the relationship, the scope, the milestones, and how we coordinate. How you are paid sits in the Compensation and Terms Schedule (Schedule A). What you create and what you bring is settled inside this letter at Section 6.8, so one signature covers the engagement and the intellectual property together. Bracketed figures shown in blue are to be confirmed by the Company before signature.

1.0 Scope of engagement

The Company engages you to lead its technology-side partnerships and to help stand up and support the development team, using your judgment, network, and standing in the sector. This engagement is built to draw on your experience building and leading companies, and on the judgment and network that come with it.

1.1 The CTO hire and the founding development team

Lead the sourcing, screening, and introduction of candidates for the Chief Technology Officer role and the founding technical hires, then work alongside the CTO to build and support the development team. The CTO target profile is a senior technologist grounded in settlement and in both centralized and decentralized exchange architecture, able to guide the buy-versus-build decisions across custody, identity, and compliance, and to dial in the minimum viable product as the Company moves toward an institutional pilot. Final hiring calls sit with the CEO, which frees you to focus on finding, vetting, and standing up the right team.

1.2 Technology partnerships

Own partnerships on the technology side: the platform, tooling, infrastructure, and technical relationships that help the build move faster. You identify, open, and shape these partnerships, keeping the CEO and the CTO in the loop on anything that touches the architecture or the roadmap.

1.3 Bridging development and marketing

Work directly with Kevin Wong to bridge the gap between what the team is building and how it is positioned and told. You help translate the development work into something the brand and go-to-market can carry, and help Kevin stay close to what is real on the technical side. The CEO is a sounding board for the two of you here, not a gatekeeper.

1.4 Advisor and sounding board

Serve as a named strategic advisor to the Company and a direct sounding board to the CEO, lending your profile and your operating experience as the Company builds toward its first pilot. Opening capital doors and lining up investor meetings is part of your first-ninety-day milestones (Section 2), always alongside Bruce Fair, who leads capital markets (Section 3.4); the Company negotiates and closes.

1.5 Cadence

The working expectation is a Weekly advisory session with the CEO, plus regular working contact with the CTO Bruce and Kevin, and reasonable availability by phone and message between sessions. The engagement is part-time and flexible; there is no fixed hour commitment.

2.0 Milestones for the first ninety days

The engagement carries defined, good-faith milestones for the first ninety days. The parties will review them together at the thirty, sixty, and ninety-day marks. They set the bar for the transition discussion in Section 4 and inform the equity review described there. They are targets for a part-time advisory engagement, not conditions of vesting unless expressly stated in Schedule A.

WINDOW	FOCUS	DELIVERABLES
Days 0-30	Learn and map	• Become familiar with the Company's internal processes, systems, and data room. • Line up interviews with ten (10) vetted CTO candidates, with the goal of one hire. • Identify the first technology-partnership targets. • Begin capital introductions and line up 10 investor meetings, working alongside Bruce and the CEO.
Days 30-60	Build the team	• Help interview and hire the Chief Technology Officer and the founding development team. • Support onboarding and team-building strategy alongside the CTO. • Begin the development-to-marketing bridge with Kevin Wong.
Days 60-90	Stand it up	• Have a full-time CTO in place. • Continue vetting and standing up the development team. • Put the first technology partnership(s) in motion. • Support the Company in securing \$500,000 to \$1,000,000 in pre-seed funding (introductions only; the Company negotiates and closes).

On the capital milestone, you open doors and line up meetings; Bruce Fair leads capital markets and the Company negotiates and closes (Section 3.4). The institutional and bank relationships remain with the CEO (Section 3.1).

On the CTO search, the target is interviews with ten (10) vetted candidates leading to one hire. If those ten do not result in a hire, the expectation continues: you keep cultivating, attracting, and helping interview candidates until the right Chief Technology Officer is placed, with the CEO conducting the interviews.

Summer timing. These milestones fall across the summer holiday months, when hiring, scheduling, and investor availability can run slower than projected. The parties acknowledge this, and the Company will take it into account in good faith when reviewing progress at the thirty, sixty, and ninety-day marks.

3.0 How we work together

A few people already own key functions at the Company. Here is how your work fits alongside them, so everyone pulls in the same direction.

3.1 Institutional relationships and revenue, with the CEO

The institutional and bank relationships, and the outreach that drives revenue, sit with the CEO. That keeps you focused on the technology, the team, and the partnerships that support the build.

3.2 Development team, with the CTO

Once the CTO is in place, the development team is built and led with the CTO. You help source, vet, and stand up the team and support it as it finds its feet; the CTO owns technical direction and delivery. You two will work closely.

3.3 Brand and marketing, with Kevin Wong

Brand, marketing, and go-to-market are led by Kevin Wong, and this is where some of your work lands. You assist Kevin to bridge development and marketing: you help him stay close to what the team is actually building, and help the build get told well. Messaging and campaigns are Kevin's to own, and public statements go out with sign-off from him and the CEO. The Company hopes you and Kevin build this relationship directly and enjoy it.

3.4 Capital markets, with Bruce Fair

Capital markets is led by Bruce Fair. Where you open a capital door, the introduction runs alongside Bruce, who sequences the outreach; term negotiation, valuation, and any commitment stay with Bruce and the CEO. Introductions you originate are recognized and tracked to you, as set out in Section 6.3 and Schedule A, and are handled by recognition rather than a percentage of capital raised, so they do not trigger dealer-registration requirements.

3.5 Legal and regulatory, with counsel

Legal and regulatory work is led by the Company's counsel. Nothing here asks you to give legal or regulatory advice, which keeps you clear of that exposure.

3.6 Decisions and authority

Final calls on hiring, terms, and commitments sit with the CEO and the Company's governance, which leaves you free to advise candidly without owning the decision. You carry no authority to bind the Company. The engagement stays advisory unless and until a defined role is agreed under Section 4.

4.0 Term and transition to a role

This engagement begins on the date both parties sign below and runs for an initial term of six (6) months. It is designed as a runway: advisor first, with a clear look at a defined role on the other side. The contemplated role is Technology Partnerships (working title), to be confirmed by fit and by the Company's needs.

4.1 Reviews

The parties will hold a 90-day review and, before the end of month five, a transition review. Reviews are run through the Advisory Council against agreed roles, responsibilities, and key performance indicators, and are kept separate from the Company's board and governance. The reviews measure the milestones in Section 2 and the working relationship.

4.2 Transition to a role

At the transition review the parties will discuss in good faith whether you move into the defined role. The role, its title, scope, reporting line, and compensation would be set out in a separate written agreement, shaped by the fit and by the Company's needs at that time. This review is also when the performance step-up to 1.00% in Section 5.1 is assessed against the milestones in Section 2. Neither party is obligated to reach agreement on the defined role. This keeps the path open without committing either side prematurely.

4.3 Termination, vesting floor, and change of control

If no role is agreed, the advisory relationship either continues on these terms by mutual agreement or ends. Either party may end the engagement on [30] days' written notice at any time. On termination, vested equity and vested legacy tokens are retained, and the confidentiality, recognition, non-circumvention, and intellectual property provisions survive.

For cause. The Company may end this engagement immediately for cause, meaning a material breach, gross misconduct, or a breach of one of the twelve (12) absolute bars of the Mission Anchor (Section 7).

Vesting floor. If the Company ends this engagement without cause, your full baseline advisory equity of 0.25% (50,000 shares) and your legacy tokens are treated as fully vested, so you keep the baseline grant in full regardless of timing. Any performance step-up under Section 5.1 that has not been earned by that date does not apply.

Change of control. On a change of control of the Company, all your unvested equity and legacy tokens vest in full (single-trigger acceleration).

Otherwise, unvested equity and tokens are forfeited on termination, subject to Schedule A.

5.0 Compensation

This is primarily an equity and legacy-token engagement, supported by a defined monthly advisory retainer whose cash payment aligns with the Company's pre-seed funding trajectory. In summary, and subject in all respects to the Compensation and Terms Schedule (Schedule A): advisory equity of 0.25% of the Company, being 50,000 Class A common shares, of which 25% (12,500 shares) is secured on signing and the balance (37,500 shares) vests over 24 months on a quarterly basis with no cliff; single-trigger acceleration on a change of control; an allocation of ten (10) legacy tokens; a monthly advisory retainer set out in Section 5.1; a performance step-up to 1.00% at the six-month review set out in Section 5.2; and a CTO placement success fee to be agreed in good faith between the parties, set out in Section 5.3.

The specific structure of the monthly advisory retainer, the performance step-up, and the CTO placement success fee is set out in the sub-sections below. The retainer is defined and payable on the schedule described in Section 5.1; there is no cash retainer payable in advance of the Company's receipt of its first pre-seed funding tranche, but time you contribute in good faith accrues and is honored as set out below.

Legacy tokens are addressed in summary here and in full in the Legacy Token Instrument. Any distribution on the legacy tokens is calculated on a defined, auditable basis set out in the instrument. If the Legacy Token Instrument does not materialize, the legacy token allocation lapses; no substitute equity or cash compensation is owed by the Company.

Recognition, not capital placement fees. This letter does not carry a fixed capital success fee. Where an introduction you make leads to closed pre-seed or seed capital, you are recognized and compensated under Section 6.3, on terms set in a separate written instrument at the time. The CTO placement success fee in Section 5.3 is distinct and specific to the Chief Technology Officer hire, and is agreed by separate written instrument between the parties.

5.1 Monthly advisory retainer

The Company will pay you a monthly advisory retainer of \$4,000 CAD, structured to align cash flow with the Company's pre-seed funding trajectory.

Accrual and invoicing. The retainer accrues from the date of this letter. You may invoice the Company monthly from that date. Each invoice is treated as an accrued and payable obligation of the Company from the date it is issued, whether or not cash payment has yet been made under this Section.

Cash payment begins on the first pre-seed tranche. Monthly cash payment of \$4,000 begins on the Company's receipt of the first pre-seed funding tranche. From that point forward, the retainer is paid monthly on standard net-30 terms from the date of each invoice.

Catch-up on pre-seed close. Any retainer that accrued between the date of this letter and the first pre-seed tranche remains an accrued and payable obligation of the Company. That accrued balance is paid in full to you on the final close of the pre-seed round.

Honoring time contributed. The Company recognizes that you may put in substantial time and effort before the Company is in a position to pay you in cash. That work will be recognized and paid. Any time you contribute in good faith to the Company between the date of this letter and the first pre-seed tranche is captured as accrued retainer under this Section, invoiceable monthly, and paid in full on the final close of the pre-seed round as set out above.

Duration. The retainer continues through the earlier of (a) the six-month term end under Section 4.0, (b) transition to a defined role under Section 4.2, or (c) termination under Section 4.3. If the engagement continues under Section 4.3 by mutual agreement beyond the initial six-month term, the retainer continues on the same terms until a defined role is agreed under Section 4.2 or the engagement ends.

Not tied to capital raised. This retainer is a fixed monthly advisory fee for the services described in Section 1. It is not tied to capital raised, deals closed, or hires made, and it is not a placement or success fee. It is compensation for time, judgment, and availability.

5.2 Performance step-up to 1.00% at the six-month review

Your baseline advisory equity is 0.25% (50,000 shares) and is yours on the terms above. In addition, your total advisory equity steps up to 1.00% of the Company, being 200,000 Class A common shares (an additional 0.75%, or 150,000 shares), if, by your six-month review (Section 4), you have both: (a) sourced and placed the Company's Chief Technology Officer; and (b) helped the Company secure between \$500,000 and \$1,000,000 in pre-seed capital, being introductions that lead to closed funding, with the Company negotiating and closing. If both are met, the additional 0.75% is granted at the review and vests over 24 months on a monthly basis, with no cliff, from the review date. If the conditions are not met, your equity remains at 0.25%. If you have met one but not both, the parties will discuss an appropriate adjustment in good faith.

5.3 CTO placement success fee

A separate success fee attaches to your successful sourcing and placement of the Company's Chief Technology Officer. The specific structure, amount, and payment terms of that success fee are to be negotiated in good faith between you and the CEO, and documented in a separate written instrument entered before or upon the placement of the CTO.

The success fee is in addition to, and not in substitution for, the performance step-up in Section 5.2. Both may be triggered independently by the same CTO placement, meaning your successful placement of the CTO may carry both the equity step-up (subject to the additional pre-seed capital condition in Section 5.2) and the CTO placement success fee.

If no separate instrument has been executed by the time of the CTO placement, the parties will discuss in good faith and set the CTO placement success fee at that time, with the intent of honoring the recognition of your role in bringing the right person to the Company.

5.4 Transfer of equity: right of first refusal

Before you transfer any equity granted under this engagement to a third party, the founders, and then the Company, have a right of first refusal to acquire it at fair market value, exercisable within [\[90\]](#) days of your written notice. Fair market value is set by the most recent priced equity round, or, absent one, by an independent valuation the parties accept. Any permitted transferee takes the equity subject to this letter and the Mission Anchor (Section 7).

5.5 Death or disability

On your death or permanent disability, your vested equity passes to your named beneficiary, subject to the right of first refusal above. The beneficiary holds it as a passive shareholder, with full economic rights but no advisory, governance, or operational role.

6.0 Relationship and conduct

6.1 Independent contractor

You act as an independent contractor, not an employee, partner, or agent of the Company. You have no authority to bind the Company, and you are responsible for your own taxes and filings.

6.2 Confidentiality

You are bound by the Mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement signed separately by the parties, which governs the confidential information exchanged under this engagement. This letter and its terms are themselves confidential.

6.3 Recognition, non-circumvention, and contact stewardship

The Company recognizes you as the originating introducer of any candidate, investor, or partner you bring to it, and will not circumvent you to deal with that party in a way that defeats compensation or recognition owed to you. Where an introduction leads to value, whether capital raised, a hire made, or a partnership formed, you are compensated for the introduction on terms set out in a separate written instrument entered at the time of the value event and worded to comply with applicable securities law. That compensation is not capped in time: if an introduced party invests years later, the introduction is still recognized, subject to the sunset below.

Contact stewardship. Once an introduced party becomes an investor, client, or partner of the Company, the relationship is in the Company's care and control from that point; the Company stewards it directly and you support it as the Company needs.

Attribution sunset. Your claim to recognition on an introduced party ends only if the Company and that party maintain an independent, direct relationship for three (3) or more years following your last active engagement with them, or if you and the Company release it in writing. Otherwise this recognition survives the end of this engagement.

6.4 Non-exclusivity and conflicts

You may hold other advisory roles, provided none creates a direct conflict with the Company. You will disclose any relationship that could reasonably be seen as a conflict, including a competing venture or a competing advisory role. The Company may engage other advisors and recruiters. A limited non-competition clause and a non-solicitation clause apply, as set out in Sections 6.5 and 6.6.

6.5 Non-competition (limited)

During this engagement and for [12] months after it ends, you will not, in Canada, directly or indirectly build, operate, advise, or hold a material interest in a business that provides a regulated settlement or interoperability layer for the exchange of tokenized real-world assets between Canadian financial institutions, in direct competition with the Company. This restriction is deliberately narrow. It does not prevent you from working in fintech, in tokenization generally, in exchanges or custody, in the same field outside Canada, or from holding the other advisory roles contemplated in Section 6.4. It is limited to the specific market the Company is building.

6.6 Non-solicitation

During this engagement and for [36] months after it ends, you will not, directly or indirectly, solicit or induce any employee, contractor, advisor, or officer of the Company to leave the Company, and you will not solicit or induce any client, institutional counterparty, investor, or partner you learned of through the Company to end or reduce its relationship with the Company. This does not stop you from general advertising not aimed at the Company's people, from responding to someone who approaches you on their own, or from continuing a relationship you brought with you and disclosed under Section 6.8. The clause is here to protect the Company's team and relationships, not to limit your career.

6.7 Company data and work product

All work product, contact records, investor and counterparty communications, and other data you generate or handle under this engagement live on the Company's platforms (its Google Drive, ClickUp, and data room) and belong to the Company. You do not keep Company data on personal systems beyond the minimum needed to deliver the service, and you return or surrender all Company data when the engagement ends.

6.8 Intellectual property and invention assignment

Assignment. All work product, inventions, code, designs, documents, content, and materials you create, conceive, or develop for the Company in connection with this engagement (the “Work Product”) are the sole property of the Company. You assign to the Company all right, title, and interest, including all intellectual property rights, in the Work Product, effective on creation. This assignment sits inside this letter, so signing the letter completes it and no separate deed of assignment is required.

Moral rights. To the extent permitted by law, you waive any moral rights you may have in the Work Product in favour of the Company and those it authorizes.

What you bring stays yours. Anything you owned or developed before this engagement, or that you develop independently outside it without using Company resources or confidential information (your “Background IP”), remains yours. List any Background IP you want to carve out in Section 6.8.1 below, or by written notice to the Company. If you build any Background IP into Work Product, you grant the Company a perpetual, worldwide, royalty-free, irrevocable licence to use it as part of that Work Product.

Contribution and credit. Where you contribute substantially to a Company invention or work product, you are named as a contributor. Recognition of your contribution does not change the assignment of ownership to the Company.

Third-party rights. You will not build any third-party intellectual property into Work Product without the right to do so, and, to your knowledge, the Work Product will not infringe the rights of others.

Further assurances. You will sign the documents and take the reasonable steps the Company needs to perfect, register, or enforce its rights in the Work Product, at the Company's expense, during and after the engagement.

6.8.1 Background IP carve-out

The following prior or independently developed IP is carved out and remains yours: [\[list items, or write “None” \]](#).

7.0 Mission Anchor

You have read the Company's Mission Anchor and acknowledge it as a binding cultural and operational commitment of the Company. You support it and will not knowingly act inconsistently with it during the engagement. Only a breach of one of the twelve (12) absolute bars of the Mission Anchor is a for-cause termination event under Section 4.3; the remainder of the Mission Anchor is a binding cultural and operational commitment and is not, on its own, a ground for termination.

8.0 Indemnification

The Company and you indemnify each other for losses caused by a breach of this letter. The Company indemnifies you for good-faith conduct within the scope of the engagement; you indemnify the Company for any unauthorized representation made on its behalf and for any breach of confidentiality.

9.0 General

9.1 Independent legal advice

You acknowledge that you have had the opportunity to obtain independent legal advice on this letter before signing it.

9.2 Governing law and dispute resolution

This letter is governed by the laws of the Province of Alberta and the laws of Canada applicable therein. The parties will first try to resolve any dispute by good-faith discussion, then by mediation under the rules of the ADR Institute of Alberta, and, failing that, in the courts of Alberta, which have exclusive jurisdiction.

9.3 Miscellaneous

This letter, together with its schedules and the documents it references, is the entire agreement between the parties on its subject and replaces any prior understanding. It may be amended only in writing signed by both parties. A failure to enforce a term is not a waiver of it. If any term is held unenforceable, the rest remains in force. It may be signed electronically and in counterparts, each an original and together forming one agreement.

10.0 Related documents

This letter is the relationship document. It is read together with, and completed by, the following:

- **Schedule A, Compensation and Terms Schedule. Equity, vesting, legacy tokens, distribution basis, change of control, any advisory fee, and expenses.**
- **Legacy Token Instrument. The definitive document behind the tokens. If the instrument does not materialize, the legacy token allocation lapses; no substitute equity or cash compensation is owed by the Company.**
- **Introduction Fee and Compensation Agreement.** The separate, securities-compliant instrument that sets the compensation on an introduction when it leads to value, entered at the time of the value event.
- **CTO Placement Success Fee Instrument.** The separate written agreement between the parties that documents the structure, amount, and payment terms of the CTO placement success fee under Section 5.3, negotiated in good faith between you and the CEO.
- **Mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement.** Two-sided protection for what each party shares, signed separately.

The definitive plan documents and the Legacy Token Instrument govern in the event of any inconsistency with the summaries in this letter.

11.0 Acceptance

If these terms are agreeable, please sign below. We are glad to have you alongside us and look forward to getting the right people in the room.

FOR THE COMPANY Signature: <u>Chad Johnston</u> Chad Johnston, 4orm Finance Date: July 7, 2026	ADVISOR Signature: <u>Dean McCall</u> Dean McCall Date: July 7, 2026
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This letter records the principal terms of the proposed advisory engagement. Bracketed figures shown in blue are placeholders to be confirmed by the Company prior to signature. The advisory equity grant and legacy token allocation are subject to the Company's definitive plan documents and the Legacy Token Instrument, which govern in the event of any inconsistency.